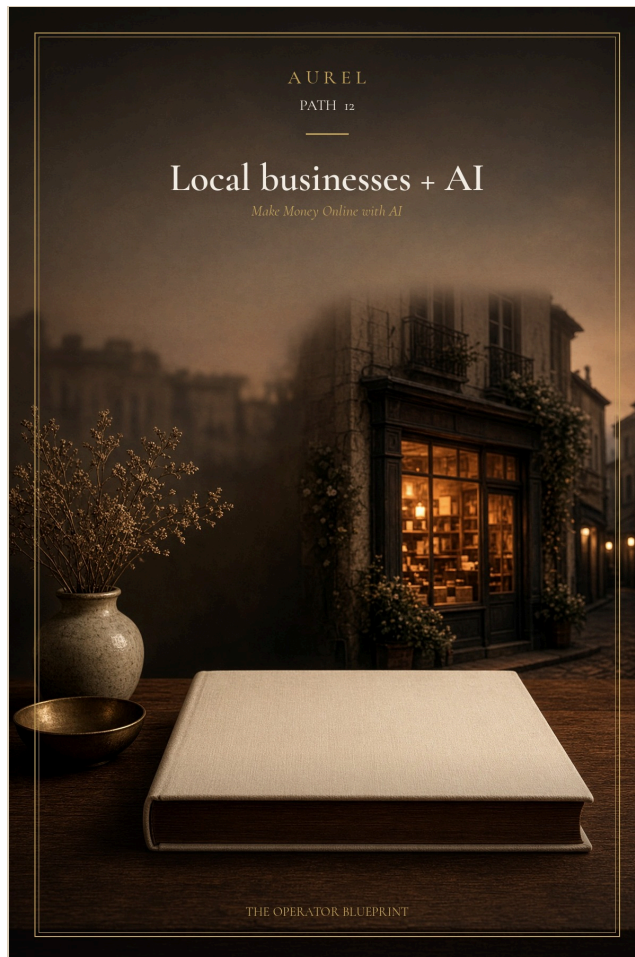




PATH 12

Local businesses + AI

Nearby owners still need pages, replies, and simple videos. Cash while digital compounds.

18 minute read · 3,870 words

Who this is for

You live near businesses that still get customers from Google, word of mouth, or a dusty site.

First sale

One local yes and a deposit.

Time to first

3–14 days of walking and writing

Cash window

\$400–\$2,000 packages

Tools

Leave this alone

A one-page PDF of the package, Stripe or e-transfer, City-wide ‘we do all AI’ agencies.
your phone.

What you are selling

A named week of work for a nearby owner. Not a 12-month ‘AI transformation.’ Not a city-wide agency. A package with a date on it: an AI-drafted page plus five posts, delivered by Friday. You edit every draft before they see it. You are the quality, not the model.

Nearby owners still need pages, replies, and simple videos. They get customers from Google, word of mouth, or a dusty site that still says ‘opening soon’ from 2019. They do not need your philosophy about large language models. They need a page that tells a human what the gym costs and five posts that do not sound like a robot moved to town.

You walk in or email with a one-page PDF. Price so one yes covers the week. Cash while digital compounds: this path pays now. The notes from the job become a playbook you can sell later to people not in your town. Do not reverse that order. Do not build the playbook instead of walking.

What this is not

This is not ‘we do all AI’ for every shop from the highway to the river. That sentence makes you look like a vendor who will vanish. One trade at a time. One package. One week. The first yes is allowed to be a small job. A 12-month retainer is a conversation after they have Friday’s files in hand.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

This path fits if you live near businesses that still get customers from Google, word of mouth, or a dusty site. You can walk into a gym or a cleaner’s office without melting. You can write a clear page in English a tired owner will recognize as their shop, not as a template from a different city.

You do not need to be a marketer of record. You need a package, a printer or a phone PDF, and the nerve to follow up the next day. Introverts can email. The work is the same: ten names, five asks, one follow-up.

Skip this if

Skip it if you want to be a city-wide ‘we do all AI’ agency. That is the thing to leave alone. You will spend a month on a pitch deck and zero days on a hallway.

Skip it if you cannot tell the owner no when they ask you to invent a claim they cannot legally make. Dentists, gyms, and cleaners all have lines. You will not be the person who writes ‘guaranteed 20 lb loss’ or ‘hospital-grade kill of every pathogen’ because the model sounded confident.

Skip it if you need to hide behind DMs with strangers in other countries this week. This path is local on purpose. The bus fare is part of the method.

The offer, named in one sentence

Write it on the PDF in a font they can read without glasses: ‘Page plus five posts this week. Deposit today, files Friday. \$800.’

That is Taylor’s pack. Yours can be the same shape at a different number inside the \$400–\$2,000 window. The shape is the product: a named week, a page, five posts (or five videos), a Friday, a deposit.

What is in

One page: home or services, written from their facts, edited by you, in a doc or CMS they already use.

Five posts: captions plus a photo brief, or five simple videos from your phone if that is the pack you named.

One round of notes, 24 hours, written.

A 15-minute walkthrough on Friday so they know which button to press.

What is not in

Ads spend. A new logo. A 12-month content calendar. A new website platform unless they already asked and you priced it as a different job. You do not sell a retainer until you have

delivered once.

What done looks like

Done for the path: one local yes and a deposit. Not a maybe. Not ‘send me something.’ Money in, date on the calendar.

Done for the week: Friday files they can use without you in the room. The page is in their voice, with their hours, their price range if they allow it, their real service list. The five posts are scheduled or sitting in a folder with the image brief. You did not paste raw model output. You cut the claims they cannot make.

The done bar

Deposit received before you draft.

Kickoff: 20 minutes or a form. Facts, photos they can send, phrases they hate, examples of posts they do not hate.

Drafts they never see until you have edited.

Friday delivery in a folder they own, plus the walkthrough.

A referral ask the same day: ‘Who else on this street should hear this?’

If you ghost after the posts go up, it is not done. It is a one-star story the next owner will hear at the coffee shop.

Price so one yes covers the week

Cash window: \$400–\$2,000 packages. Taylor’s ‘page plus five posts this week’ sits at \$800. That number should cover your hours, your walking, and the fact that you cannot sell Friday twice.

\$400–\$500 is a founder pack if you need the first case and you will write that on the PDF as a first-seat price with a date it expires. \$800 is the default once you have one sample page made from public info. \$1,200–\$2,000 when the page is a full services rewrite plus five videos, or when the owner has two locations.

Deposit

50% to start, 50% Friday before the walkthrough, or 50/50 with the balance on delivery. E-transfer, Stripe, whatever they already use. Do not start a draft on a handshake. Local does not mean casual about money. Local means you might see them at the grocery store, which is why a clean PDF and a clean invoice matter more, not less.

Do not discount to ‘win the street.’ One \$800 yes is the week. Two \$300 maybes is a mess. Do not sell a 12-month retainer at a mystery rate until they have seen Friday once. A retainer, later, can be \$1,200 a month for four posts a week. That is a different PDF. After.

The first 72 hours

Write the one-pager. List ten businesses. Visit or email five. Follow up the next day. The first yes is allowed to be a small job.

Hours 1–8

One trade. Taylor starts with cleaners, then walks gyms with the same pack. You start with one. Learn ten phrases they use: ‘booth,’ ‘membership freeze,’ ‘move-out clean,’ ‘drop-in.’ Write the PDF: headline, what is in, Friday, \$800, deposit, your phone, two sentences of proof if you have any (a sample page from public info counts).

Build one sample from a real local site that is dusty. Rewrite their home section in a doc. Watermark SAMPLE. You will show it, then offer to do theirs properly with their facts.

Hours 9–48

List ten. Visit or email five. Walk-in: ‘I am not selling a 12-month thing. One page, five posts, this week, \$800. PDF is one page. Can I leave it with you?’ Email: six lines, the PDF, the sample, a Friday date you can actually hit.

Hours 49–72

Follow up the next day. In person or one line: ‘I can still start this week if the deposit lands today. Friday files either way.’ Do not add a second package. Do not redesign the PDF. Walk the next five

if the first five were silent.

The path, step by step

Step 1. One trade. Learn their language. Cleaners, gyms, dentists, trades. Read five of their Google reviews. The words customers use are the words on the page. ‘They actually showed up’ is a better headline than ‘synergized cleaning solutions.’

Step 2. The named week on one PDF. Page plus five posts this week. Deposit today, files Friday. \$800. Print ten copies. Phone PDF for the ones who will not take paper.

Step 3. A sample made from public info. Their dusty site, rewritten in a doc, SAMPLE across it. Then: ‘I can do yours properly with your facts.’ Do not pretend you already work there.

Step 4. Ten names, five visits or emails. Hallway, front desk, or the contact form they ignore. You are not a city-wide blast. You are a person on this street.

Step 5. Follow up the next day. One time, clearly. Owners are busy, not coy. If they say no, ask who else on the block would want Friday files. If they say later, put a date.

Step 6. Deposit. Kickoff. Money, then a 20-minute fact pull: hours, services, prices they will print, photos, phrases to ban, claims they must not make. Write the bans down.

Step 7. Draft with the model. Edit like you live here. AI can draft. They never see the raw pass. Cut fake urgency. Cut medical or chemical claims. Put the real cross-street in the copy. Put the real parking note.

Step 8. Deliver Friday. Folder they own. Page in a format they can paste. Five posts with the photo brief. Fifteen-minute walkthrough. Balance paid.

Step 9. Ask for a referral to the next owner on the same street. Same day. ‘If this saved you a headache, who else should I walk to before I go home?’

Step 10. Do not ghost. A text on Monday: ‘Any post you want swapped?’ One check-in. Then stop hovering. You are not their staff.

Step 11. Notes from the job become a playbook. The phrases, the claims you refused, the kickoff questions. That file can sell to cleaners in other towns. Later. After cash this week.

Step 12. Only then, a second week or a retainer. Same pack for the gym two doors down, or a monthly at a written rate. Not a 12-month contract sold on day one. Not a new trade on the other side of the city until this street has seen you deliver.

Worked example: Taylor walking gyms and cleaners

Taylor lives in a town where the highway gyms have new paint and the independent ones have a Facebook page last updated for a New Year promo. The cleaners are busier than they look. Taylor is not an agency. Taylor has a phone, a one-page PDF, and a week to fill.

The pack

‘Page plus five posts this week. Deposit today, files Friday. \$800.’ In: one services or home page, five posts (caption plus what to photograph), one round of notes. Out: ads, logos, a new website builder. Sample attached: a rewrite of a cleaner’s public home page, SAMPLE watermark, with the fake claims stripped.

Taylor printed twelve PDFs at the library. Listed ten cleaners and eight gyms. Day 1 was the PDF. Days 2–4 were walking. Cleaners in the morning (owners actually in). Gyms at 10:30, between classes, not at 5pm.

The first yes

A two-van cleaning company. The owner had been meaning to ‘fix the site’ for a year. The sample looked like her shop instead of a national franchise. She asked if Taylor could also promise ‘hospital-grade’ in the copy. Taylor said no: ‘I will not write a claim you cannot stand behind. I will write that you are bonded, that move-outs take a day, and that you text an ETA. \$800. 50% today.’ E-transfer on the van hood. Kickoff in the office: 18 minutes, a list of services, three photos from her camera roll, a ban list.

Taylor drafted that night. Edited the next morning — the model had added ‘eco-certified’ which they were not. Five posts: a before-and-after (with permission), a move-out checklist, a ‘what we

will not do' post that built trust, a hiring post for a third van, a Friday availability. Delivered Thursday night, walkthrough Friday. Asked for a referral before leaving. The owner named a gym two streets over whose manager also cleaned for her once.

What happened

Elapsed from first print to deposit: 6 days. Inside 3–14. Taylor walked the gym the same Friday with the cleaner as the intro, not as a secret. Second pack, same \$800, gym language swapped in ('drop-in,' 'freeze,' 'no contract shame'). Did not sell a 12-month retainer. Did not open a city-wide AI shop. Notes went into a doc that later became a \$19 playbook for cleaners in other towns. The week's cash was the \$800. The playbook was the compound.

Copy you can paste

One-pager headline

Page plus five posts this week. Deposit today, files Friday. \$800.

One-pager body

You get a services page written from your facts, plus five posts you can publish this week. I draft with AI. I edit every line before you see it. You get one round of notes. You do not get a 12-month contract, a new logo, or claims you cannot stand behind.

50% to start. Files Friday. Walkthrough Friday. Balance on delivery.

Walk-in line

I am not selling a 12-month thing. One page, five posts, this week, \$800. The PDF is one page. Can I leave it with you?

Email

Hi [name] — I rewrote a sample from your public page (attached, marked sample). I can do yours properly with your facts this week: one page, five posts, \$800, deposit today, files Friday. If the

timing is wrong, ignore this. If a neighbor should see it, tell me who.

Kickoff questions

Hours, service list, anything you will not do

Prices that are allowed on a page

Claims I must not make

Three photos I can use

Phrases you hate

Where the page actually lives (WordPress, Squarespace, Facebook only)

Friday ask

If this saved you a headache, who else on this street should I walk to before I go home?

Week-by-week

Day 1: PDF. Sample page from public info. Ten names. Price on the paper.

Days 2–4: ten visits (or five visits and five emails). Follow up the next day. Do not redesign the offer.

Week 2: deliver and ask the next owner on the same street. Deposit, kickoff, draft, edit, Friday files. Referral the same day. If the first yes was a cleaner, the second walk is a gym or the next cleaner, not a dentist in another town.

Week 3: same pack, full price if you discounted. Write the SOP: kickoff questions, ban list, delivery folder template. A Monday check-in text, then you stop hovering.

Week 4: notes into a playbook draft for people not in your town, or a monthly PDF for the owner who already has Friday files. Do not sell the retainer to a stranger who has not seen you deliver. Do not hire two subcontractors and call yourself an agency.

The quality bar

You are the quality, not the model. If they can tell a chatbot wrote the page, you undercharged their trust and overcharged their Friday.

Edit like you live here

Real hours. Real cross-street. Real parking. Real name of the owner if they want it. No ‘revolutionizing the wellness space.’ No stock photo of a city that is not this one.

Claims

Gyms: no guaranteed body fat numbers. Cleaners: no medical kill-claims unless they have the certificate in a drawer and want it cited. Dentists (if you ever go there): you are not their clinical copywriter. When unsure, cut the line. Write what they do, when they do it, what it costs, how to book.

Delivery

A folder they own. File names a human can read. Posts in the order of the week. Photo briefs that a person with a phone can shoot in ten minutes (‘van in the driveway, 3pm light, no logo overlay’). A walkthrough. Then space.

Ghosting after the posts go up is a quality failure. So is dumping five raw AI captions into their Messenger at 11pm Thursday.

What to measure

The first sale is one local yes and a deposit. Measure movement toward that, then toward Friday.

Names on the list vs visits or emails this week. Ten and five is the 72-hour bar.

Follow-ups sent the next day. Zero follow-ups is how nice PDFs die on a counter.

Days from first walk to deposit. 3–14 is the window. At day 15 with no yes, the PDF is mush or you only visited friends.

Hours from kickoff to Friday files. If it took 18 hours of drafting, your edit pass is too precious or the kickoff missed the facts.

Referral asked, referral given. One name from a happy Friday is worth ten cold gyms.

Claims you refused. Log them. That log is how you stay out of trouble and how the playbook later teaches.

Do not measure 'brand awareness on the street.' Do not measure likes on their posts as your scorecard unless they paid you to run ads, which they did not.

Objections you will hear

'My nephew does Facebook.' Good. This is one page and five posts this week, then you are gone. Nephew can keep the page. You are not replacing their family. You are clearing a backlog.

'Can you just show me a free sample on our account?' No. Doing the work free as a trial is a mistake this path does not survive. The SAMPLE rewrite from public info is the sample. Deposit starts theirs.

'We need to go viral.' You are not promising that. You are promising Friday files. If they want ads, that is a different pack and a different number.

'\$800 is a lot.' One yes covers the week. A cheap website someone never finished already cost them more. If \$800 is wrong, \$400 founder-rate with an expiry date is allowed once. \$0 is not a price.

'Put that we are the best in the city / hospital-grade / guaranteed results.' No. You will not make claims the owner cannot legally make. Offer three true lines instead.

'Can you start and we will pay Friday if we like it?' No. Deposit today. Files Friday. Like-it is what the revision round is for, not what payroll is for.

What this path feeds next

Cash this week is the point. Compound is the notes.

The kickoff questions and the claims you refused become a \$19 playbook for cleaners or gym owners you will never drive to. The five-post structure becomes a template you can sell. A local yes who is happy is a case study (with permission, real name, real town).

The same street becomes a retainer after one delivered week. The same pack becomes five videos instead of five captions if they have a phone and a doorway. Do not turn it into a city-wide agency. The next path is a product, not a headcount.

If you also make printables, the cleaner's 'move-out checklist' can be a \$9 page. If you also do long-form, 'how independent gyms explain drop-ins' is a video. Feed those after Friday, not instead of walking.

Mistakes that kill this path

Doing the work free as a 'trial.' They now have your Friday. You have a maybe.

Making claims the owner cannot legally make. You will both wear that copy.

Ghosting after the posts go up. The coffee-shop review writes itself.

Selling a 12-month retainer before you have delivered once. You do not know their approval speed. They do not know your Friday.

City-wide 'we do all AI' positioning. One trade, one pack, one street.

Starting the draft before the deposit. Starting a second trade in another town while five local names sit unvisited.

Letting them see raw model output. Your name is on the walk-in. The model does not walk in.

Tools

A one-page PDF of the package. Headline, in/out, Friday, \$800, deposit, phone. Printed and on your phone.

Stripe or e-transfer. Whatever the owner already trusts. Invoice with the week's date on it.

Your phone. Camera for samples, maps for the ten names, email, a notes app for the ban list. Five videos, if that is the pack, are also the phone.

A doc for drafts. You write. They receive a clean file, not a chat log.

The model, privately. Drafts only. Never a login you share with the owner as the product.

You do not need a CRM in week one. A list of ten in a notebook is a CRM. You do not need a team. You need shoes that can do four visits in an afternoon.

Checklist

One trade chosen, ten phrases learned from reviews

One-pager PDF: page plus five posts this week, \$800, deposit today, files Friday

Sample rewrite from public info, marked SAMPLE

Ten names on a list

Five visits or emails

Follow-up the next day

Deposit before any draft

Kickoff facts and a written ban list for claims

AI draft edited by you; they never see the raw pass

Friday folder, walkthrough, balance

Referral ask: next owner on the same street

Monday check-in text, then no ghosting and no hovering

Notes saved for a later playbook

No 12-month retainer sold before one delivered week

FAQ

Gyms or cleaners first?

One trade first. Taylor walked cleaners in the morning because owners were on site, then used a referral into a gym. If you have a membership or a mop, start where you already know the words. Same PDF shape. Different nouns.

What if they have no website, only Facebook?

The 'page' is a Facebook services post or a Google Business profile rewrite. Name it on the PDF so they are not expecting a custom domain. Still \$800 if the work is the same. If it is truly smaller, \$400 and still a Friday.

Do I need insurance or an LLC?

A one-page agreement: deliverable, date, price, claims, who owns the copy (they do, on payment). Deposit. Local rules on business licenses vary. Do not let paperwork delay the first five visits. Do not skip the agreement.

Can I do this by email only?

Yes if you will actually send five and follow up. Walking still wins in small towns. Mix it. The path is 'visit or email,' not 'wait to be discovered.'

What about dentists and medical trades?

Same pack, tighter ban list. You do not write clinical promises. If you are not willing to cut lines, skip that trade.

How do I handle an owner who wants endless rewrites?

One round, 24 hours, written notes. Then \$150 for another round. Put it on the PDF. Unlimited is how Friday never comes.

Should I hire someone to walk for me?

No. Not until you have delivered three Fridays. The walk is how you learn the language. A hired body with your PDF is the agency you were told to leave alone.

Can the five posts be videos?

Yes if the PDF says so. Five simple phone videos, same \$800 or \$1,200 if you are also on camera. Do not surprise them with captions when they expected video, or the reverse.

What if the first ten say no?

Follow up once. Ask for a name. Walk the next ten in the same trade. Change the sample, not the whole business. Day 14 with zero deposits means the ask is fuzzy or you never mentioned the price on the paper.

When do I sell the playbook?

After one paid week, when the notes are real. The playbook is for owners you will not drive to. It does not replace the walk this month. Cash while digital compounds — in that order.